

WHERE IN THE **WORLD**



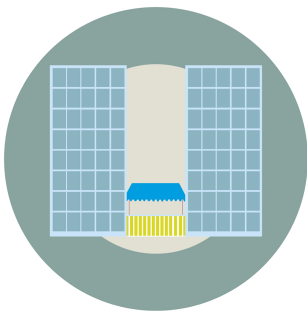
Natural resources are plentiful in some places in the world and scarce in others. For example, in some countries water is freely available, but in others it's valuable enough for people to fight over. Control of resources such as oil or minerals, gives countries political clout.

TOO MUCH **CHOICE**



Competition pushes producers to offer better products at lower prices. But while consumers have more choice of products to buy, there's often a confusingly large number of very similar products. Faced with too many alternatives, with only slight differences, consumers find it difficult to make a good choice.

A NICHE IN THE **MARKET**



When starting up a business or launching a new product, it's important to be competitive. It isn't enough simply to have a good product, especially if someone else is already selling something similar. To find a place in the market, your product needs to satisfy a demand that isn't already being met. This is known as filling a niche in the market.